

PHIL 2021.01 (CRN 23694) Ancient Philosophy

TR: 9:30-10:45
Room: 115 Burgett
Instructor: Errol Katayama
Office Hrs.: MW 9:00-11:00; TR: 1:30-2:30 pm or by appt.
E-mail: e-katayama

Fall 2025-26
Credit: 3.0
Office: 122 Burgett
Phone: 2204

Catalog Course Description:

Greek philosophical traditions against the background of the Pre-Socratics and Socrates, with a special emphasis on Plato and Aristotle

Course Prerequisite: None, but one course in philosophy or at least sophomore standing is strongly recommended.

Texts:

Richard D. McKirahan, *Philosophy Before Socrates*, 2nd Edition (Hackett, 2010).

ISBN-13: 978-1-60384-182-5

G.M.A. Grube, trans., *Plato: Five Dialogues*, 2nd edition (Hackett, 2002).

ISBN 0-87220-633-5

G.M.A. Grube, trans., *Plato: Republic* (Hackett, 1992).

ISBN 0-87220-136-8

Apostle and Gerson, trans., *Aristotle: Selected Works*, 3rd edition (Peripatetic, 1991).

ISBN 0-911589-13-9

Outline:

Week 1: *Tues Aug 26*: Introduction; **Pre-Socratics (with an emphasis on Parmenides)**

McKirahan (Chapters 1-6, pp1-57)

Thurs Aug 28: McKirahan (Chapters 7-10, pp58-144)

Week 2: *Tues Sept 2 & Sept 4*: Parmenides

McKirahan (Chapter 11, pp145-173)

Week 3: *Tues Sept 9*: McKirahan (Chapters 13-14, 16, pp193-292, 303-342)

Thurs Sept 11: Assignment on Parmenides

Week 4: *Tues Sept 16*: **Plato**: Plato: Five Dialogues: (*Apology*)

Thurs Sept 18: Plato: Five Dialogues: (*Euthyphro*)

Week 5: *Tues Sept 23*: Plato: Five Dialogues (*Meno*)

Thurs Sept 25: Plato: Five Dialogues (*Phaedo*)

Week 6: *Tues Sept 30*: *Republic* 1

Thurs Oct 2: *Republic* 2-3

Week 7: *Tues Oct 7: Republic 4*
Thurs Oct 9: Republic 5-7

Week 8: *Tues Oct 14: Fall Break (No Class)*
Thurs Oct 16: Republic 8-9

Week 9: *Tues Oct 21: Republic 10*
Thurs Oct 23: Review of Plato

Week 10: *Tues Oct 28: Aristotle: Categories, chapters 1-5*
Thurs Oct 30: Physics, 1

Week 11: *Tues Nov 4: Physics 2-3*
Thurs Nov 6: Assignment on Plato

Week 12: *Tues Nov 11 & Thurs Nov 13: On the Soul 2*

Week 13: *Tues Nov 18: On the Soul 3(up to chapter 5)*
Thurs Nov 20: Nicomachean Ethics 1

Week 14: *Tues Nov 25 & Thurs Nov 27: Thanksgiving Break (No Classes)*

Week 15: *Tues Dec 2: Nicomachean Ethics 2-3*
Thurs Dec 4: Nicomachean Ethics 6

Week 16: *Tues Dec 9: Nicomachean Ethics 10*
Thurs Dec 11: Assignment on Aristotle

Course Objectives:

- (1) To write effective abstract of paper with a thesis statement and summary on the selected topic of Parmenides, Plato and Aristotle.
- (2) To summarize their arguments.
- (3) To critically analyze their arguments.

Requirements:

A short paper (1200 words) on Parmenides (Due: Mon Sept 13)	40 points
A mid-term paper (2000 words) on Plato's <i>Republic</i> (Due: Mon Nov 8)	70 points
A final paper (2000 words) on Aristotle (Due: Before 11:15 am Tues Dec 16)	70 points
Class Participation	20 points

Total: 200 points

Scale of Grading:

- A: 180-200 points
- B: 160-179 points
- C: 140-159 points
- D: 120-139 points
- F: less than 120 points

Attendance:

Aside from the policy of the University, that all students are expected to attend all classes, there will be no attendance policy that directly affects your grade. You will be treated like a responsible adult; that means, regardless of your absence, you will be fully responsible for the material covered in the classes. For most, if not all, of you will find the readings very challenging. You should take the full advantage of the class time to make sure that you understand the readings. Most importantly, you should expect that your papers will be evaluated on that assumption that you have had the benefit of the lectures as well as class discussions. Your papers should take all the relevant points we raised in the class that are pertinent to your topic into account. Note that, for my record, I shall take attendance. In addition, I will also follow the general guidance and rules of contacting students and reporting to other offices (e.g. Dean's and Registrar's) for lack of attendance. Those of you who happen to come in late (that is, after the attendance is taken at the beginning of the class), unless you want to be technically absent, it is your responsibility to come and see me after the class to notify me of your presence.

Expectation and Class Participation:

You are expected to have read the assigned reading materials for the class and to be prepared to discuss them. NOTE: all the relevant information including all the handouts will be available on Canvas. My policy is to credit up to 10 % of the grade (i.e. 20 points) to the student who has *substantially* participated in the philosophical discussion throughout the semester in the class. Class participation is expected from all of you. And be prepared to be called upon; however, no one will be penalized for the lack of participation; that is, no final grade will be lowered due to the lack of it. Class participation will only count towards improving your final grade.

ONU Policies:

"Ohio Northern University is dedicated to providing an equitable educational experience for all enrolled students. Universal course policies applicable to all courses can be found at the following link: https://my.onu.edu/registrar's_office/policies. Specifically, this website includes the policies for the following topics:

- Academic Dishonesty Policy
- Academic Accommodations Policy
- ONU Mercy Health Center Policy
- Title IX Policy
- Cancellation of In-Person Instruction
- Proctorio software (testing in a distance, hybrid or technology enhanced classroom)

Academic Misconduct Policy –The specific guidelines for this course are as follows:

No forms of academic dishonesty, such as cheatings and plagiarism, or helping someone cheat (e.g. showing your work), will be tolerated and they are subject to disciplinary action. You are to do all your assignments (unless otherwise instructed) independently by *yourself*. Uses of resources other than your text, lecture notes and the information posted by me in the course found on Canvas (again unless otherwise instructed) are forbidden; that is, you are not allowed to use any information obtained anywhere else, including the use of AI. If you have any question or problem with your assignments, you are to consult me. The expected penalty for academic dishonesty on *any* assignment is **a failed grade for the course** (not the assignment itself). Note this penalty applies to graduating seniors as well.

AI Policy:

Use of AI to understand the course materials, to summarize the argument, and to help write your papers (or any other purposes for the class) are forbidden. Depending on the extent in which the paper relies on AI, your paper will be penalized accordingly – the penalty may include not only the failure of the paper but also the course. So, do not use it. You are expected to read the texts on your own (using the class lecture and notes as a guide). If you do not understand the materials, you will have ample opportunities to aske questions in class and to come and see me during my office hours.

Cancellation of In-Person Instruction Policy

In the event of cancelation of in-person class meeting, due to inclement weather or otherwise, except an email from me with an instruction to complete course material asynchronously online.